
Handout, Session 3: Your wallet, seed phrase, and first sats

Keep this page. It is your reminder for staying safe with your wallet.

A wallet holds keys, not coins

Your sats live on the Bitcoin network. Your wallet holds the **keys** that prove the sats are yours. Think of two parts:

- **Receive address:** like your email address. Share it so people can send you sats.
- **Private key and seed phrase:** like the password to your email. Never share it. Whoever has it controls the money.

Remember the saying: **Not your keys, not your coins.**

Custodial vs self-custodial

- **Custodial:** a company holds your keys. Easy to start, and they can help you recover access. But they can freeze your money and you depend on them. Fine for small amounts.
- **Self-custodial:** you hold your own keys. No one can freeze or confiscate your sats. You carry full responsibility, so your seed phrase matters.

Your seed phrase: the most important rules

Your wallet will show you 12 or 24 words. This is the master key to all your sats.

- **Write them on paper, by hand, in the exact order, numbered.**
- **Never take a photo of them.**
- **Never type them into any website.**
- **Never put them in notes, messages, or email.**
- **No real support person will ever ask for your seed phrase.** Anyone who asks is trying to rob you.
- **Keep the paper safe and dry, where only you can reach it.**

- If you lose both your phone and your seed phrase, your sats are gone for good. With your seed phrase, you can always restore your wallet on a new phone.

How to receive sats

1. Open your wallet and tap **Receive**.
2. Show the QR code or share your address.
3. The sender scans or pastes it and sends.
4. Watch your balance update. A Lightning payment usually arrives in seconds.

Your receive address is safe to share. It cannot be used to take your money.

How to send sats

1. Tap **Send**.
2. Scan the recipient's QR code, or paste their address or invoice.
3. Enter the amount in sats.
4. **Double-check the amount and the recipient.**
5. Confirm and send.

Payments cannot be reversed. Always check before you confirm.

Wallets mentioned today (neutral options)

- **Blink:** easy to start with Lightning.
- **Phoenix:** self-custodial Lightning.
- **Machankura:** Lightning over USSD for basic feature phones, no smartphone needed.
- Hardware or seed-phrase wallets for savings.

[CONFIRM: which options work in this country, and which one the class used today,
[primary wallet] .]

An honest note

This course gives no financial advice and makes no price predictions. Bitcoin's price in [local currency] can rise and fall.

Glossary of terms: [../ ../ ../translations/GLOSSARY.md](https://satsontheroad.com/translations/GLOSSARY.md)